project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

# Bearing True Witness

Grades 5–8 · Religion

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

## 01 PART 1 The Eighth Commandment

> *You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor.*
>
> EXODUS 20:16

This commandment tells us to be truthful. "Bearing false witness" means lying or deceiving others. God calls us to be people of truth!

## 02 PART 2 What Does This Mean Today?

Bearing **FALSE** witness includes:

- Lying about someone
- Spreading gossip or rumors
- Sharing things online that aren't true
- Creating or sharing fake images to deceive people

Bearing **TRUE** witness means:

- Telling the truth, even when it's hard
- Checking if something is true before sharing it
- Protecting other people's reputations
- Admitting when we're wrong

## 03 PART 3 True Witness or False Witness?

For each situation, circle TRUE WITNESS or FALSE WITNESS:

1. Sharing a funny meme about a classmate without checking if it's mean — TRUE WITNESS / FALSE WITNESS

2. Telling a friend "I don't know if that rumor is true" instead of spreading it — TRUE WITNESS / FALSE WITNESS

3. Checking if a news story is real before telling your family about it — TRUE WITNESS / FALSE WITNESS

04 PART 4

## My Commitment to Truth

I, _____ , commit to being a person of truth.

One way I will bear true witness this week:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

**Signature:** _____

05 PART 5

## Jesus and Truth

> *Jesus said to him, 'I am the way, and the truth, and the life.'*
>
> JOHN 14:6

For Christians, Jesus IS truth. When we commit to truth-telling, we follow Jesus!

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

Spirit photographers in the 1860s created fake "ghost" images and sold them to grieving families. They bore false witness through pictures — deceiving people for money. Today, fake photos and videos ("deepfakes") can spread even faster online.

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Talk with your family about the Eighth Commandment. Ask: "Have you ever seen something online that turned out to be false? How did you find out the truth?"

PRAYER

*Lord, help me to be a person of truth. Give me courage to speak honestly and wisdom to recognize falsehood. May my words and actions honor you. Amen.*